THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** rhyme and sound alike	Sound play.
2	**(a)** Custard's looks and his nature	Contrast.
3	**(b)** sword	Weapon.
4	**(d)** invented words for humour	Playful language.
5	**(a)** an amused observer	Third person.
6	**(a)** coward	Derived.
7	**(b)** the timid dragon is the real hero	Reversal.
8	**(d)** humorous simile	As ... as.
9	**(d)** tells a story	Narrative.
10	**(a)** create comedy	Humour.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	They rhyme and sound silly (1) like Ink, Blink, Mustard and Custard (1).	1+1
12	He saves everyone (1) yet still wants a safe cage (1).	1+1
13	As brave and loving (1) with a household of strange pets (1).	1+1
14	It is absurd and funny (1) because bears in a barrel are not brave (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Funny names (1). Exaggerated boasts (1). Comic twist at the end (1).	1+1+1
16	Comparisons (1). Pirate's weapons (1). Dragon's looks (1).	1+1+1
17	The pets said that they were brave (1). Tense backshift (1). Pronoun change (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Custard is fierce-looking and timid (1). Others boast of bravery (1). In danger they flee while he fights (1).	1+1+1
18	Danger over (1). Heroes praised (1). Funny final twist (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Although Custard was afraid, he fought the pirate (1). 'Although' shows contrast (1). Complex sentence (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Names (1). Exaggeration (1). Irony (1). Rhyme (1). Twist (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Definition (1). Examples (1). Effect (1). Humour (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Boasters (1). Custard (1). Pirate scene (1). Outcome (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Custard (1). Meaning (1). Examples (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** He is a hero but unchanged	Irony.
2	**(d)** invented words and absurd humour	Absurd.
3	**(b)** lack of confidence	Timidity.
4	**(d)** a comic villain	Stock villain.
5	**(c)** boasting	Brag.
6	**(c)** acts bravely when needed	Courage.
7	**(b)** serious tragedy	It is a comedy.
8	**(b)** doing the right thing despite fear	Definition.
9	**(d)** a light-hearted tale	Fun.
10	**(c)** humour	Indirect.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It is bouncy and quick (1) matching the comic tone (1).	1+1
12	It has a dragon, a pirate and a girl (1) with a simple moral and happy end (1).	1+1
13	Danger tests each character (1) and reveals who is truly brave (1).	1+1
14	To make their later cowardice funnier (1) and to show boasting is empty (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Couplets (1). Bounce (1). Made-up words (1).	1+1+1
16	Treats small events with grand style (1). Comic effect (1). Seen in comparisons (1).	1+1+1
17	The timid dragon hid (1). Do not boast of bravery (1). Both words used correctly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A dragon is expected to be fierce (1). Custard is timid (1). The tale shows him as brave in deed (1).	1+1+1
18	Simple story (1). Rhyme (1). Clear moral (1).	1+1+1
	OR: bravery (1). fear (1). boast (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Theme (1). Humour (1). Language (1). Rhythm (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Intro (1). Details (1). Quotes (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Both humorous (1). Narrative vs instruction (1). Irony in both (1). Rhyme (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Names (1). Sound pairs (1). Invented words (1). Effect (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** The Dragon Who Saved the Day	Fits.
2	**(d)** they were chosen for sound and humour	Playful.
3	**(c)** Belinda cried out for help.	Reporting an exclamation.
4	**(c)** comic and surprising	Surprise.
5	**(b)** couplets (aabb)	Pairs.
6	**(c)** The pirate was swallowed by Custard.	Past passive.
7	**(a)** children and adults	Broad appeal.
8	**(c)** words are not equal to deeds	Message.
9	**(c)** quickly	Modifies verb.
10	**(d)** gentle irony	Irony.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He is the threat (1) that tests the heroes (1).	1+1
12	Custard looks fierce but is timid (1) and the 'brave' pets run away (1).	1+1
13	Courage can exist in a fearful heart (1) and is shown in action (1).	1+1
14	It is funny and rhythmic (1) and its message is simple (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Boasters are untrustworthy (1). The pets ran away (1). Real deeds count (1).	1+1+1
16	Boastful talk (1). Quiet deed (1). Humility (1).	1+1+1
17	It means to show cowardice (1). The pets ran away (1). It fits their behaviour (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A little white house with tiny pets (1). Contrasts with a dragon and a pirate (1). Small and large clash (1).	1+1+1
18	He feels insecure (1). He prefers safety (1). He is gentle (1).	1+1+1
	OR: 'The Dragon Who Wanted a Cage' (1). It highlights the irony (1). It is catchy (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Opening (1). Pets (1). Pirate (1). Climax (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Pets' apology (1). Custard's reply (1). Cage (1). End (1).	2+2+1
20	Characters (1). Setting (1). Dialogue (1). Action (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Looks vs nature (1). Boast vs deed (1). Ending (1). Message (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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